HARD HITTING

LENA WILDE

TONI ARCHER

VS

LENA WILDE

Fri, Oct 16

Dallas National Guard Armory
Dallas TX



“Hard Hitting”

The camera opens on a small television studio set. A plain curtain hangs behind Lena Wilde with a simple UPW sign off to one side. A wooden chair sits nearby.

Lena stands in front of the backdrop in her wrestling gear, wrists taped. No entrance, no introduction. She looks straight into the camera.

LENA: “Toni Archer… at this point, you and I aren’t strangers.”

“We’ve stood toe to toe. We’ve traded blows. We’ve fought each other on the floor while Carter Shaw walked away with something both of us came there to win.”

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"You know enough about me to know why I came to UNIQUE. You don't know everything, but you know the name of the demon I came here chasing."

"But that's not what matters Friday night."

"What matters, Toni, is what you don't know."

Lena raises one fist slightly.

"You know they call me Hard-Hitting Lena Wilde."

"You sat there and said I hit hard, but you hit harder."

She pauses.

"Maybe you do."

"But you don't know what it took for me to earn that name."

"Like you and plenty of others like to point out, I'm five feet tall. Ninety-eight pounds."

"So yeah, I've spent a lot of my life proving I'm not somebody you get to push around."

"Back home in Dade City, I learned that young. When you're the smallest one around, people test you. Girls twice your size. Boys looking for somebody they think won't hit back. People who see an easy target before they ever bother to learn your name."

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Lena's expression hardens.

"I learned to hit back."

"And after a while, I learned that hitting back wasn't always enough."

"You've gotta hit hard enough that they remember it."

"And I've had people do a lot worse than push me around. I've had somebody make it her mission to make my life a living hell. Tried to embarrass me. Tried to break me. Tried to convince me I didn't belong."

Lena pauses.

"I didn't talk my way out of that."

"I hit my way out."

"That's why I hit hard, Toni."

"I had to."

"That's where that name came from."

She raises her fist again.

Slight pause.

"It's not some slogan somebody handed me. Not because it sounded good on a poster."

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“I earned it.”

“Every time somebody counted me out. Every time somebody decided I didn’t belong. Every time somebody thought they could make a name for themselves by stepping on me.”

She pauses.

“And believe me, Toni… you’re not the first pretty girl with a big opinion who looked at me and thought she could do what I do better than I can.”

“But you didn’t live what I lived. You didn’t have to become what I became.”

Just the slightest smirk.

“So when you say I hit hard, but you hit harder… I hear you.”

“I just don’t think you know yet what you’re comparing yourself to.”

Lena holds the stare for a second longer.

Then she drops her fist, turns, and walks off the set without another word.

The camera lingers on the empty spot where she was standing before the picture cuts away.